

RIAMRIAM PEACE AND DEVELOPMENT NETWORK (RPDN)

Organizational Profile | 2026 Edition

 Kenya / East Africa

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 RIAMRIAM Peace & Development Network – Turkana, Karamoja, Toposa & Nyangatom

Motto

“Building Peace. Empowering Communities. Transforming Lives.”

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1. Executive Summary

RIAMRIAM Peace and Development Network (RPDN) is a community-driven Community-Based Organization (CBO) and civil society organization dedicated to promoting peace, social cohesion, resilience, and sustainable development among vulnerable and marginalized communities across the Ateker corridor and wider East African region.

Originally formed in 2000 and revived and re-institutionalized in 2026, RIAMRIAM works closely with local communities, youth, women, elders, traditional institutions, civil society actors, governments, and development partners to address the root causes of conflict, insecurity, poverty, exclusion, and underdevelopment.

Through integrated peacebuilding initiatives, governance programs, humanitarian response, climate-resilient livelihoods, advocacy, education, and community empowerment, RIAMRIAM strengthens social cohesion and improves the quality of life in fragile and underserved regions.

The organization believes that sustainable peace and inclusive development are interconnected and can only be achieved through community participation, dialogue, accountability, justice, and equitable access to opportunities.

2. Background and History

2.1 Formation of RIAMRIAM

RIAMRIAM was formed in the year 2000 as a grassroots peace initiative in response to persistent insecurity, cattle rustling, intercommunal conflicts, and cross-border tensions affecting Ateker communities across Kenya, Uganda, South Sudan, and Ethiopia.

The initiative emerged during a period when pastoral communities—including the Turkana, Karimojong, Toposa, Nyangatom, Dassanach, Pokot, and Samburu—experienced recurring violence driven by competition over grazing land, water resources, livestock theft, political marginalization, and weak cross-border coordination.

The organization was revived and re-institutionalized in 2026 to strengthen regional peacebuilding, development coordination, and institutional sustainability.

2.2 Meaning of “RiamRiam”

The name *RiamRiam* originates from the Ateker cultural tradition meaning **“meeting and meeting again.”**

It symbolizes:

- Continuous dialogue
- Reconciliation
- Cooperation

- Peaceful coexistence

Historically, RiamRiam gatherings served as traditional peace forums where elders, women, youth, and neighboring communities resolved conflicts, renewed peace agreements, negotiated shared resources, and strengthened social bonds.

Today, the name reflects RIAMRIAM's commitment to:

- Sustainable peacebuilding
- Cross-border diplomacy
- Community-led dialogue
- Social cohesion
- Inclusive development across the Ateker corridor

3. Organizational Identity

3.1. Vision

A peaceful, resilient, inclusive, and prosperous region where communities coexist harmoniously in dignity, security, and sustainable development.

3.2. Mission

To promote peace, social cohesion, and community-led development through peacebuilding, humanitarian action, advocacy, governance strengthening, and sustainable livelihoods across the Ateker corridor and neighboring regions.

3.3. Core Values

- Peace and Nonviolence
- Integrity and Accountability
- Human Dignity
- Inclusivity and Equity
- Community Participation
- Transparency
- Innovation and Learning
- Gender Equality
- Partnership and Collaboration

4. Context and Problem Statement

4.1. Communities within RIAMRIAM's operational areas continue to face interconnected social, political, environmental, and economic challenges including:

- Intercommunal and resource-based conflicts
- Cross-border cattle rustling and insecurity
- Climate change and recurrent drought
- Food insecurity and livelihood loss
- Youth unemployment and criminal recruitment
- Drug abuse and gang emergence
- Gender inequality and GBV
- Weak governance and political incitement
- Limited access to education, healthcare, and clean water
- Humanitarian crises and displacement
- Marginalization of pastoral and indigenous communities

4.2. Key Structural Challenges

4.1. Conflict and Insecurity

- Cross-border raids involving Toposa, Nyangatom, Dassanach, and Karimojong communities
- Inter-county clashes between Turkana, West Pokot, Baringo, Samburu, and Marsabit
- Clan-based exclusion and resource conflicts
- Emergence of armed youth gangs

4.2. Weak Peace Infrastructure

- Erosion of elders' authority
- Weak cross-border grazing agreements
- Inadequate coordination mechanisms

4.3. Climate Vulnerability

- Recurrent droughts
- Degraded rangelands
- Water scarcity
- Fisheries insecurity along Lake Turkana

4.4. Youth Crisis

- High unemployment
- Drug abuse
- Criminal exploitation by political and business interests

4.5. Institutional Weakness

- Fragmented coordination
- Weak governance systems

- Limited donor access for grassroots institutions

RIAMRIAM responds to these challenges through integrated, community-led, and conflict-sensitive interventions.

5. Geographical Scope of Operations

RIAMRIAM operates primarily within pastoral and underserved regions across East Africa.

5.1 Primary Focus Areas – Turkana County

- Intra-county political tensions
- Clan-based exclusion
- Lokichar oil corridor conflicts
- Youth radicalization and gang emergence

5.2 Inter-County Focus

- Turkana – West Pokot
- Turkana – Baringo
- Turkana – Samburu
- Turkana – Marsabit

5.3 Cross-Border Focus

- Kenya – Uganda (Karamoja Cluster)
- Kenya – Ethiopia (Nyangatom & Dassanach Corridor)
- Kenya – South Sudan (Toposa Corridor)

The organization also works in:

- Conflict-affected rural communities
- Borderland regions
- Vulnerable urban settlements
- Pastoral migration corridors

6. Program Goal and Strategic Objectives

6.1 Goal

To build peaceful, resilient, and self-reliant communities across Turkana, West Pokot, Baringo, Samburu, Marsabit, Karamoja, and neighboring Ateker regions where trust, cooperation, and sustainable development thrive.

6.2 Overall Objective

To restore peace, trust, and social cohesion within the Turkana–Pokot–Samburu–Karamoja–Toposa–Nyangatom–Dassanach corridor while enabling sustainable development, economic resilience, and community-led security.

6.3 Specific Objectives

1. Strengthen community-led and cross-border peace structures
2. Establish functional Early Warning and Early Response (EWER) systems
3. Reduce youth involvement in violence and criminal networks
4. Promote climate-resilient and diversified livelihoods
5. Establish women peace networks and kraal councils
6. Strengthen governance and institutional accountability
7. Sustain intra-community and cross-border dialogue platforms
8. Improve conflict monitoring and rapid response systems
9. Promote youth and gender-inclusive governance
10. Improve resource-sharing and climate adaptation mechanisms
11. Foster social cohesion, trust, and regional collaboration

7. Core Program Areas

7.1 Peacebuilding and Conflict Resolution

- Community dialogue forums
- Mediation and reconciliation
- Peace education campaigns
- Cross-border diplomacy
- Early warning systems
- Anti-cattle rustling initiatives

7.2 Governance and Civic Engagement

- Civic education
- Leadership training
- Policy advocacy
- Citizen participation forums
- Governance strengthening

7.3 Livelihoods and Economic Empowerment

- Vocational and entrepreneurship training
- Climate-smart agriculture
- Pastoral support systems
- Fisheries and agro-processing
- Youth and women empowerment

7.4 Gender and Social Inclusion

- Women leadership programs
- GBV prevention and response
- Girls' empowerment
- Disability inclusion initiatives

7.5 Humanitarian and Emergency Response

- Emergency relief support
- Food security interventions
- WASH programs
- Disaster preparedness and resilience

7.6 Youth Development

- Youth mentorship and leadership
- Sports for peace
- Skills development
- Countering violent extremism

7.7 Education, Research, and Capacity Building

- Institutional strengthening
- Research and advocacy
- Training workshops
- Community awareness campaigns

8. Integrated Strategic Framework

8.1 Five Strategic Pillars

Pillar 1: Peace and Governance

- Cross-border peace councils
- Elders' courts and customary justice systems
- Dialogue forums
- Multi-agency coordination

Pillar 2: Early Warning and Rapid Response

- Community EWER systems
- Peace monitors and mediation teams
- Digital reporting systems
- Rapid mediation mechanisms

Pillar 3: Youth Transformation and Crime Prevention

- Youth peace brigades
- Vocational training
- Youth incubation hubs
- Crime prevention initiatives

Pillar 4: Climate-Resilient Livelihoods

- Peace markets and pasture banks
- Fisheries and agro-processing
- Natural resource management
- Blue economy initiatives

Pillar 5: Institutional Strengthening

- Governance and financial systems
- Strategic planning
- Operational manuals
- Regional and international partnerships

8.2 Thematic Pillars of Intervention

1. Peace & Security Zones
2. Community Protection & Early Warning Systems
3. Youth Cooperatives & Transformation
4. Cultural Governance & Kraal Courts
5. Peace Markets & Cross-Border Trade
6. Climate-Resilient Livelihoods
7. Advocacy, Human Rights & GBV Prevention
8. Political Accountability & Governance Oversight
9. Urban Peace & Inclusive Business
10. Annual Peace & Cultural Festivals

8.3 System Logic

- Security without justice collapses
- Justice without livelihoods fails
- Livelihoods without culture fracture
- Culture without accountability stagnates

8.4 Theory of Change Statement

If RIAMRIAM strengthens community-led peace structures, promotes inclusive governance, empowers women and youth, supports climate-resilient livelihoods, revitalizes traditional conflict resolution systems, and enhances early warning and response mechanisms,

Then vulnerable communities across the Ateker corridor will reduce violence, strengthen social cohesion, improve resilience, and increase inclusive participation in governance and development processes,

Because empowered communities with functional peace systems, sustainable livelihoods, accountable institutions, and inclusive participation are better able to resolve conflicts peacefully, withstand shocks, and pursue sustainable development.

9. Governance and Leadership

9.1 Governance Structure

RIAMRIAM maintains a transparent and accountable governance structure consisting of:

- Board of Directors
- Executive Leadership Team
- Program Management Team
- Technical and Field Staff
- Community Volunteers and Peace Committees

The organization promotes participatory leadership, professionalism, accountability, and ethical governance.

9.2 Founders and Leadership Profiles

1. Mr. Peter Eripete

Distinguished public servant and national intelligence expert with extensive experience in conflict analysis, peace negotiation, security management, and cross-border peace initiatives.

2. Mr. Peter Lotesiro

Former Deputy Governor and Arid Lands Coordinator with expertise in pastoral livelihoods, climate resilience, and governance in ASAL regions.

3. Mr. David Ateyo

Former teacher and founder of the original RIAMRIAM initiative with experience in NGO management, civic engagement, and peace education.

4. Missionary Joseph Elim

Former CEO of RIAMRIAM, teacher, and missionary with expertise in faith-based leadership, peacebuilding, and community development.

5. Alexander Losikiria

Former Sub-County Administrator and former CEC Lands with experience in governance, land management, and institutional development. Currently serves as CEO of RPDN.

6. Christopher Eregae

Teacher and community mobilizer experienced in grassroots coordination, youth engagement, and dialogue facilitation.

7. Seline Locham

Community leader and women's empowerment advocate experienced in grassroots mobilization, peacebuilding, Resource mobilization and resilience programs among pastoralist communities.

8. Jane Apetet Nachida

Community development practitioner and educator with expertise in peace and development, youth and women mentorship, and advocacy for vulnerable groups.

9. Rebeca Ekuam

Diplomat and peace advocate experienced in embassy service, community outreach, conflict resolution, resource mobilization, and women and youth empowerment initiatives.

10. Emmanuel Imana Ichor.

A seasoned peacebuilding expert and philanthropist experienced in conflict resolution, community mediation, humanitarian support, and youth and community empowerment initiatives.

Leadership Summary

The founders collectively bring expertise in governance, peacebuilding, security, education, humanitarian action, diplomacy, and grassroots mobilization, positioning RIAMRIAM as a culturally grounded and credible institution for sustainable peace and development.

10. Institutional Capacity

RIAMRIAM possesses strong grassroots credibility and operational capacity supported by:

- Experienced leadership and technical teams
- Community-based networks and volunteers
- Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability, and Learning (MEAL) systems
- Financial management and compliance systems
- Conflict-sensitive programming approaches
- Strong stakeholder engagement mechanisms

The organization continues investing in institutional growth, technology, and sustainability.

11. Partnerships and Collaboration

RIAMRIAM values strategic partnerships for sustainable impact and collaborates with:

- Local communities and traditional leaders
- Government institutions
- Civil society organizations
- International NGOs
- Development agencies
- Faith-based organizations
- Youth and women networks
- Kraal and peace committees
- Academic and research institutions

These partnerships strengthen coordination, innovation, and collective action for peace and development.

12. Achievements and Impact

Since 2000, RIAMRIAM has contributed to:

- Strengthening community peace structures
- Facilitating mediation and reconciliation initiatives
- Supporting women and youth leadership development
- Improving social cohesion among conflicting communities
- Supporting vulnerable households through livelihood programs

- Enhancing civic participation and governance engagement
- Building resilience to climate and humanitarian shocks
- Training community peace actors and facilitators

13. Success Stories

13.1 Community Reconciliation Initiative

RIAMRIAM facilitated dialogue between conflicting communities, resulting in peaceful coexistence agreements and restored social relations.

13.2 Women Peace Champions

Women trained through RIAMRIAM programs became influential mediators and advocates for peace and social cohesion.

13.3. Youth Economic Empowerment

Youth supported through entrepreneurship and vocational training established businesses and reduced vulnerability to violence and crime.

13.4 Climate Resilience Support

Pastoral households adopted sustainable livelihood practices that improved food security and drought resilience.

14. Expected Outcomes

RIAMRIAM seeks to achieve:

- Reduced conflict incidents and cattle raids
- Stronger peace structures
- Functional early warning systems
- Improved social cohesion and trust
- Increased youth employment and economic participation
- Enhanced climate resilience
- Improved governance and accountability
- Greater women and youth participation in decision-making
- Strengthened regional peace infrastructure

15. Strategic Priorities (2026 and Beyond)

Over the next five years, RIAMRIAM aims to:

1. Expand peacebuilding and conflict prevention programs
2. Strengthen climate resilience and sustainable livelihoods
3. Increase women and youth participation in governance
4. Scale humanitarian and resilience initiatives
5. Strengthen institutional sustainability
6. Enhance advocacy, research, and policy engagement
7. Build stronger regional and international partnerships
8. Promote innovation and digital inclusion

16. Contact Information

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Social Media

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